

Exponential change has now become a buzzword, but the power of an exponential curve is rarely considered. Each year will entail greater change than the year before. Such a concept differs drastically from a linear rate of change, where the future will change just as quickly as the past did (see [Figure I.1](#).) The two may appear similar in the early days of change, but when the exponential curve starts to inflect it quickly, and at times violently, it distinguishes itself.

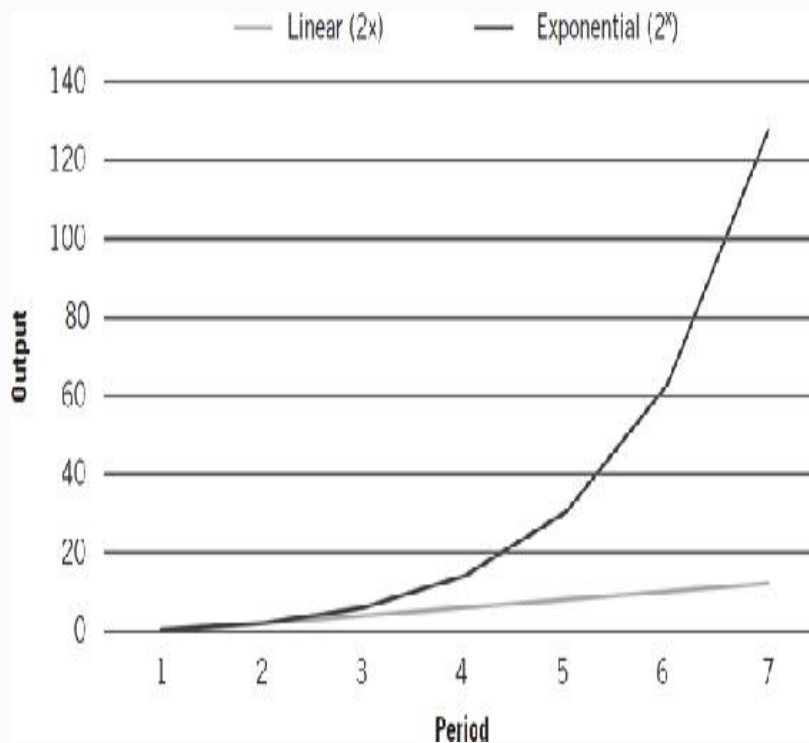


Figure I.1 ■ Exponential versus linear rates of change

While year 1 exhibits the exact same value for linear and exponential change in [Figure I.1](#), as does year 2, by year 7 an exponential rate has progressed nearly tenfold more than the corresponding seventh period of linear change. We often operate with the rough assumption that the rate of change over